



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Bishop Ryan Catholic School
School Website: <https://bishopryan.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Austin Classical School

Website audited: <https://austinclassical.org>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Austin Classical School presents strong, explicit classical-Christian identity across mission, aims, curriculum, and pedagogy. The site foregrounds formation in wisdom and virtue ordered to truth, goodness, and beauty; integrates Scripture and theological study throughout the program; implements the Trivium, Great Books, Socratic practice, memorization/recitation, and senior thesis; and articulates partnership with families ("co-laboring with families"). Evidence for formal liturgical practices (e.g., daily chapel) and explicit parent-formation programming is less visible on public pages, but the core signals firmly meet classical standards. Key strengths include: - Purpose and goal centered on formation in wisdom and virtue and the transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) ; aligned to "Six Elements" positive indicators for Purpose/Goal . - Deep theological grounding (mission to "glorify Jesus Christ," Scripture as "holy, inerrant, infallible" and central to wisdom) with substantial Christian Studies (exegesis, apologetics/ethics, church history) ; aligned to Religious & Metaphysical positive indicators in the "Six Elements" document . - Robust curriculum (Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, history-by-name, rhetoric and senior thesis) and pedagogy (Socratic method, debate/discussion, imitation, memorization/recitation) ; matching Curriculum and Pedagogy positives in "Six Elements" .

Below is the required keyword analysis and category-by-category scoring.

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

1) Keywords found on school site (verbatim/near-verbatim):

- "glorify Jesus Christ"; "classical, Christian education"
- "begin and end our search for wisdom in the pages of the Bible, God's holy, inerrant, and infallible Word" (Scripture central)
- "Christian Studies" with Exegesis, Hermeneutics; Church History; Apologetics & Ethics (required in upper school)
- Frequent use of "wisdom," "virtue," "truth, the good, and the beautiful"

2) Comparison to "Six Elements" positive/negative indicators:

- Positive matches: theology, sacred scripture, Christian formation, moral theology, revelation; transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom; virtue) .
- Liturgical terms (e.g., "chapel," "liturgy," "hymnody") not explicitly present on public pages (neutral).
- No negative markers (e.g., "values-neutral," "subjective truth") observed.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive keyword hits: +12
- Negative keyword hits: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage of sub-criteria: ~67% (2 of 3 strongly evidenced: transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical practice not explicit)

4) Rating justification: CLASSICAL The site clearly affirms theological integration and transcendental moral realism; liturgical/communal worship practices are not explicit, but overall signals meet classical standards for this category (keywords map to positive list) .

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

1) Keywords found:

- “The Aim: To cultivate wisdom and virtue”
- “Method: contemplation of the True, the Good, and the Beautiful”
- Mission: “co-laboring with families to cultivate wise, virtuous, and humble students”

2) Comparison to “Six Elements”:

- Positive matches: cultivation of wisdom and virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation over information .
- No negative markers (e.g., “college and career ready” emphasis) observed.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +8
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: 100% (all three Purpose/Goal criteria strongly evidenced)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

1) Keywords found:

- Trivium and stages explicitly: Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric; methods: “memorization, recitation, and songs”; Logic: “debate and discussion”
- “Great books,” “great conversation”
- Upper School courses list “History” (Ancient; Medieval & Renaissance; U.S. History) by name (not “social studies”); required Latin; Classical Rhetoric & Composition; Senior Thesis; Intermediate Logic; Rhetoric Choir (music credit)
- “We study those great books, and we are unapologetic about doing so” (Bible central to the great conversation) and the community listens to seniors defend a thesis

2) Comparison to “Six Elements”:

- Positive matches: Seven Liberal Arts/Trivium; Great Books and Great Conversation; historical engagement; Latin; rhetoric; logic .
- “Wonder” is implied through transcendentals but not named explicitly.
- No negative markers (e.g., “social studies curriculum,” STEM-first framing) observed.

3) Quantitative estimate:

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- Positive hits: +12
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage: ~75% (3 of 4: Trivium/Latin/Great Books/history clear; “wonder” term not explicit)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (TEACHING METHODS)

1) Keywords found:

- “memorization, recitation, and songs” (Grammar stage)
- “debate and discussion” (Logic stage)
- “We employ the Socratic method in our classrooms” (truth-testing)
- “Students ... analyze famous speeches ... practice the art of rhetoric mostly by means of imitation” (upper-school rhetoric)
- “Thesis defense and eloquent written and oral communication” (Rhetoric stage)

2) Comparison to “Six Elements”:

- Positive matches: Socratic seminar/dialectic; memorization/recitation; imitation; rhetoric/oratory .
- “Restful learning”/scholé not explicitly stated on site (neutral).
- No negative pedagogical markers (e.g., “project-based only,” “experiential learning” dominance) visible.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +10
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: ~75% (3 of 4: Socratic; memory/recitation; imitation/rhetoric present; scholé not explicit)

4) Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

1) Keywords found:

- “Head of School who loves Jesus and loves people” and “talented and dedicated teachers who enjoy serving God ... using the classical approach” (Faculty & Staff summary)
- Employment page referenced (qualifications listed)

2) Comparison to “Six Elements”:

- Positive alignment language suggests “teachers as models of virtue” and mentoring, but explicit phrasing like “portrait of a teacher/student,” “faculty collegium,” or “living curriculum” not shown on public pages .
- No negative markers.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: +3
- Negative hits: -0
- Percent positive: 100%
- Coverage: ~50% (virtue-modeling implied; collegiality/portrait less explicit)

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- 4) Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Public materials indicate faithful, mission-aligned faculty and classical approach; further explicit articulation of teacher-formation/mentorship vision would strengthen this category.
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- 1) Keywords found:
- Mission: “co-laboring with families” (strong partnership signal)
 - Admissions requires a “family interview” (parent partnership/engagement)
 - “Listen as a community to Seniors present and defend a thesis” (community engagement)
- 2) Comparison to “Six Elements”:
- Positive matches: partnership with families; community practices that transmit culture and affections (shared public defense of ideas) .
 - No explicit parent-formation programs noted on public pages (neutral).
- 3) Quantitative estimate:
- Positive hits: +4
 - Negative hits: -0
 - Percent positive: 100%
 - Coverage: ~67% (2 of 3 evidenced: partnership + community; explicit parent education not shown)
- 4) Rating: CLASSICAL
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Aggregate Judgment

- Category ratings: R/M Foundations (Classical), Purpose/Goal (Classical), Curriculum (Classical), Pedagogy (Classical), Faculty (Somewhat Classical), Parents/Community (Classical).
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL

The school’s public materials align closely with the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” positive indicators across purpose, theology, curriculum, and pedagogy, with minor gaps in explicit statements about faculty formation structures and liturgical practice terms on public pages .

Evidence Appendix: Key On□Site Passages (select)

- Mission: “exists to glorify Jesus Christ ... co-laboring with families ... classical, Christian education”
 - Aim/Method/Tools (wisdom/virtue; true, good, beautiful; Trivium, Great Books)
 - Socratic method stated; imitation in rhetoric; senior thesis and community listening
 - Upper School plan naming History (not “social studies”), Latin, Logic, Classical Rhetoric & Composition, Apologetics & Ethics, Exegesis/Hermeneutics; Rhetoric Choir; thesis defense
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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